

A RED SQUIRREL CAN JUMP UP TO 6½ FT (2 M) BETWEEN TREES—10 TIMES ITS OWN BODY LENGTH



IN BRITAIN, THERE ARE AN ESTIMATED 140,000 RED SQUIRRELS, COMPARED TO 2.5 MILLION GRAY SQUIRRELS

Social dynamics

Red squirrels spend most of their time alone, but will huddle in groups in nests on cold nights, or gather together when food is plentiful.

Cold taiga habitat
Across Siberia, the red squirrel lives in the great taiga forest: a vast expanse of pine and spruce trees on the edge of the cold Arctic region.

Coniferous habitats

Pine seeds are a favorite of red squirrels, so they are especially abundant in pine forests. They hoard pine cones, seeds, and nuts as a winter store—particularly when food crops are low during the coldest months.

Tufted ears

Red squirrels have distinctive tufts of fur on their ears, which grow longer in winter months.

Staying active

Even in the coldest winters, red squirrels do not hibernate for long periods, as many small mammals do. Instead, they may stay snug in their nests in bitter weather.

Chisel-like teeth

Like other rodents, red squirrels have chisel-like front incisor teeth. They use these to bite into the woody shells of nuts to reach the nutritious seed inside.

Colorful fur

Most red squirrels have reddish-brown fur with a white underside, but some individuals are black, brown, gray, or even blueish.

KEY

 Eurasian red squirrel range

